

30 CHAPTERWISE IMPORTANT QUESTIONS

English Language and Literature (184) | CBSE 2026-27

A Tiger in the Zoo

First Flight - poem | Board-examinable literature

30 original revision questions with answers: short-answer, competency, assertion-reason and long-answer practice. Set is based on the current syllabus and official question-paper style; it is not a prediction or an official CBSE paper.

Question 1

How is the tiger's life in the cage different from life in the forest?

Answer:

In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. In the forest he would move freely, hunt, and live in his natural habitat.

Question 2

Why does the tiger ignore the visitors?

Answer:

The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. His silence and fixed stare suggest anger and helplessness rather than acceptance.

Question 3

What does the poem ask readers to think about?

Answer:

It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity. The contrast invites readers to value wildlife protection and animals' natural environments.

Question 4

What is the central idea or skill tested in A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

The central focus is: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. This is the starting point for a strong answer from this chapter.

Question 5

Write two relevant points for a short answer based on A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

First point: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Second point: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. Link the two points clearly instead of listing them without explanation.

Question 6

How does the first key idea in A Tiger in the Zoo lead to an important result or conclusion?

Answer:

Begin with the key idea: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Then connect it to the result: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration.

A Tiger in the Zoo - Continued

Question 7

What evidence, calculation, incident or concept best supports the first main idea in A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

Use this supporting detail: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. In the forest he would move freely, hunt, and live in his natural habitat. The relevant detail should be stated before giving the final conclusion.

Question 8

Explain the importance of the second major idea in A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. His silence and fixed stare suggest anger and helplessness rather than acceptance. Its importance lies in showing how the chapter develops the topic beyond a simple fact or definition.

Question 9

What common mistake should a student avoid while answering a question from A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

Do not give only a conclusion. Explain the reasoning with a correct detail, such as: It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity.

Question 10

Compare the first and second important ideas in A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

The first idea is: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. The second idea is: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. A complete comparison states both the difference and the connection between them.

Question 11

Show a cause-and-effect link from A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

Cause or starting point: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Effect or outcome: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. Use connecting words such as 'therefore', 'as a result', or 'thus'.

Question 12

What is the most useful sequence for explaining the main content of A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

A clear sequence is: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Next, The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. Finally, It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity.

A Tiger in the Zoo - Continued

Question 13

Give a 40-50 word answer outline for an important question from A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

Start with the direct answer: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Add one supporting point: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. End with the outcome or message: It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity.

Question 14

How should you support an English literature answer from A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

Use a relevant incident, character action, theme, or poetic image: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Then explain what it reveals about the character, situation, or message.

Question 15

How can an examiner see that you understand, rather than memorise, A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

Connect the idea to its reason or result. For instance: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. Then explain why this point matters in the chapter's context.

Question 16

State one inference that can be drawn from the main situation or concept in A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

A sound inference is that it draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity. This inference must be supported by a relevant point from the chapter.

Question 17

Frame a short competency-based response using the first two ideas in A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

Apply the concept by first stating: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Then justify the response with: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration.

Question 18

What would make an answer from A Tiger in the Zoo incomplete?

Answer:

An answer is incomplete if it omits the explanation or final implication. Include both: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Also add: It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity.

A Tiger in the Zoo - Continued

Question 19

Prepare an Assertion-Reason style explanation based on A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

Assertion: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Reason: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. Check whether the reason actually explains the assertion before choosing an option.

Question 20

How should you justify an answer from A Tiger in the Zoo in two clear steps?

Answer:

Step 1: state the concept or event - In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Step 2: support it with the explanation or result - The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration.

Question 21

What answer structure is suitable for a 3-mark question from A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

Use three connected points: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity. Keep the points specific and write them in a logical order.

Question 22

What answer structure is suitable for a 5-mark question from A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

Give an introduction, develop these key points - In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. - and close with: It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity. Add a diagram, equation, example, or textual reference where relevant.

Question 23

How can the ideas in A Tiger in the Zoo be applied to a new situation or case study?

Answer:

Identify the relevant principle first: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Then use the chapter's reasoning to explain the case: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration.

Question 24

Which detail from A Tiger in the Zoo is most likely to earn an extra mark when explained correctly?

Answer:

A useful detail is: It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity. Explain it in context instead of using it as an isolated statement.

Question 25

Write a brief concluding statement for an answer on A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

A suitable conclusion is: It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity. This conclusion should follow naturally from the explanation rather than introduce a new point.

A Tiger in the Zoo - Continued

Question 26

Make a three-point revision note for A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

1. In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. 2. The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. 3. It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity. Revise these points with the chapter's examples, terms, and practice questions.

Question 27

How would you self-check an answer from A Tiger in the Zoo before submitting it?

Answer:

Check that you have answered the exact question, used the key idea - In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. - and supported it with a reason, example, calculation, or outcome such as: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration.

Question 28

Why does A Tiger in the Zoo remain important for revision?

Answer:

It combines factual recall with explanation and application. The main takeaways are: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity.

Question 29

Create a final 60-80 word answer plan for a long question from A Tiger in the Zoo.

Answer:

Opening: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. Development: The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration. Conclusion: It draws attention to the loss of freedom animals face in captivity. Use complete sentences and include all required evidence, steps, or references.

Question 30

What is one last-minute revision question you should ask yourself about A Tiger in the Zoo?

Answer:

Ask: 'Can I explain why this is true or important?' A correct self-answer should include: In the cage he paces within a narrow boundary and can only watch people. and The visitors are separated from him by barriers and cannot understand his frustration.

Sources: CBSE English curriculum 2026-27; CBSE Class X sample papers and marking schemes 2026-27; NCERT textbooks.